

## Early Years (3–5)

*Short steps, said out loud, in the same order every day. At this age the routine works better as a rhythm you narrate than a list they read.*

|                                    |                                |                                      |                                        |                                      |                                        |
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| <b>B</b><br>Behaviour has a Reason | <b>R</b><br>Record the Pattern | <b>I</b><br>Identify One Shared Goal | <b>D</b><br>Design Matching Strategies | <b>G</b><br>Give Consistent Language | <b>E</b><br>Evaluate & Adjust Together |
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*These routines put D: Design Matching Strategies into practice: everyday steps simple enough to actually stick, at home, on a real weekday morning.*

### BRIDGE tip: G. Give Consistent Language

When a transition is the hard part, name the feeling first, then offer a choice: “You don’t want to stop playing. That’s hard. Do you want to walk to the car like a bunny hop or a robot?” The same two phrases, used every day, become a script your child can predict.

### Morning

- **WAKE 6:30** Wake up, get dressed (with help)
- **EAT 6:45** Eat breakfast together
- **BRUSH 7:05** Brush teeth and hair
- **SHOES 7:15** Shoes, bag, and coat by the door
- **HUG 7:25** Quick cuddle, then goodbye

### After School

- **SNACK 3:30** Big hug and a snack
- **PLAY 3:45** Free play or quiet time
- **DINNER 5:30** Dinner as a family
- **SHOWER 6:30** Bath, pajamas, story
- **SLEEP 7:00** Lights out

**What helps at this age:** a visual chart with pictures instead of words, the same 2–3 songs or phrases to signal each step, and a five-minute warning before transitions.

*MettleNest exists to make behaviour support practical, respectful, and within reach.*

*These routines are one small piece of the BRIDGE Method, the same shared framework taught to parents and educators so a child gets consistent support at home and at school.*

**Connection • Collaboration • Communication**